

Drowning

History

- Total time of submersion?
- Water temperature?
- Trauma?

Hypothermic Cardiac Arrest

- Cardiac drugs are usually ineffective in very hypothermic cardiac arrest

Note:

- Definition of "drowning": **respiratory impairment from submersion/immersion in liquid**
- If the patient is improving clinically over 4 hours and did not need formal resuscitation, the patient should be offered transport to the hospital but may be observed on site.
- If the patient needed formal resuscitation or the cough and respiratory symptoms have not resolved after 4 hours, the patient should strongly be encouraged to be evaluated in the emergency department

EMT/AEMT

- Follow General Medical Care Guideline
- Follow Adult Resuscitation Guideline, as indicated
- Remove patient from water – maintain C-spine precautions, if concern for trauma
- Remove wet cold clothes, warm patient as indicated

Bronchospasm with Wheezing

- Follow Difficulty Breathing - Asthma and COPD Guideline

Cardiac Arrest

- **Emphasize primary ventilation and oxygenation** - Continue with positive pressure ventilation through copious amount of foam that may present in the airway
- Start CPR and utilize AED

Cardiac Arrest with Hypothermia

- Go to Hypothermia Guideline
- Survival is not likely for submersion for >30 minutes in water greater than 43° F (6° C)

Paramedic

- Advanced airway as indicated. Emphasize ventilation and oxygenation.
- 12 – Lead EKG (if available)
- Follow Cardiac Arrest guideline
- Follow Hypothermia guideline